

Mitsue Project — Presentation Script

Introduction

Good [morning / afternoon], everyone. Thank you for being here.

My name is Rob Oudendijk. I'm an engineer with over 35 years of experience in Japan — 13 years in Tokyo, 2 years in Fukushima, and the last 15 years in Mitsue, Nara.

Living in this village, I've seen firsthand the challenges facing rural Japan. And I've also watched the world's demand for energy — driven by AI, data centers, and electric vehicles — grow faster than ever.

That gap gave me an idea.

The Mitsue Project

The Mitsue Project turns that gap into an opportunity. It connects rural problems with modern energy needs — and solves both at the same time.

The Challenges We're Addressing

In rural areas:

- Overgrown forests and wildlife pressure
- Depopulation
- Aging infrastructure

In energy and technology:

- Massive energy demand from AI and data centers
- Lack of EV charging in rural areas
- The need to reduce our carbon footprint

Our Approach

We use timber from neglected sugi (cedar) forests to fuel a biomass CHP unit — combined heat and power. That energy runs a village microgrid, EV charging stations, and a carbon-neutral AI data center.

The forest gets restored. The village gets energy and jobs. Technology gets the clean power it needs.
